ASPREDICTED

Wharton CREDIBILITY LAB
UNIVERSITY of PENNSYLVANIA



# PREVIEW: *ELU-foraging project, October 2026*

**ıor(s)**
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pect your answers below, and if no changes are needed you may approve the pre-registration.
our answers have any symbols or special characters we recommend you check out the .pdf preview.

**nission**

**ıve any data been collected for this study already?**
ıo data have been collected for this study yet.

**hat's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?**
ary hypothesis: We will test whether early-life unpredictability is associated with uncerta itive planning during sequential foraging. Based on our original study, we predict that greater e npredictability, as measured by the QUIC Factor 1 score, will be positively associated with the mo ed uncertainty-sensitive discounting parameter.
further predict that greater uncertainty-discounting rate will be associated with gre harvesting, defined as planet residence time relative to the Marginal Value Theorem (MVT) optir uncertainty-discounting rate will statistically mediate the association between ELU Factor 1 harvesting.
ociation hypothesis: We predict that the association between ELU Factor 1 and uncerta ounting rate will remain significant after accounting for lifetime trauma exposure (LEC-5) and cu D symptoms (PCL-5)

**escribe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.**
primary dependent variable is the participant-level uncertainty-sensitive discounting param ıated using the same Bayesian structure-learning and adaptive-discounting model.
primary behavioral outcome is overharvesting, defined at subject-level as mean planet resid (PRT) minus the residence time prescribed by the Marginal Value Theorem (MVT), aggreg ss planet types.
ndary model-derived variables include baseline discounting and the structure-learning param

stionnaire predictors will include the prespecified QUIC Factor 1 score, PCL-5 total score, LI na-load scores.

**ow many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?**

articipants will complete the same sequential foraging task and the same questionnaire ba C, LEC-5, PCL-5).

in the foraging task, all participants experience three within-subject planet types differing in re etion rate (poor, neutral, and rich) and both common no-switch and rare switch transitions betv et types.

**pecify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.**

nodel fitting, questionnaire scoring, and behavioral variables will be specified prior to examining cation results and will follow the procedures used in the original study. The QUIC factor structure pe re-estimated in the replication sample. Instead, QUIC Factor 1 will be calculated from the fa ysis established in the original study and will serve as the preregistered ELU predictor. Similarly ary PTSD measure will be the PCL-5 total score.

ary replication analysis: We will calculate the Spearman correlation between QUIC Factor 1 rtainty-discounting rate . The predicted direction is positive.

will also calculate a Spearman correlation between uncertainty-discounting rate and subject- n overharvesting (PRT − MVT). We will also examine the association between baseline uncert overharvesting as a validation analysis.

iation analysis: We will estimate a subject-level mediation model with QUIC Factor 1 as the predi rtainty-discounting rate as the mediator, and mean overharvesting as the outcome.

cificity analysis: We will use multiple linear regression to predict uncertainty-discounting rate dardized QUIC Factor 1, PCL-5 total, and LEC-5 trauma load together. We will conduct sepa els using the conservative, stringent, and liberal LEC-5 scores rather than entering all three h elated scores at once. We predict that the coefficient for QUIC Factor 1 remains positive stically significant after adjustment for these measures.

**escribe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for exclu rvations.**

will use the same behavioral inclusion criteria as in the original study. (1) passed the instruction fewer than three attempts, (2) passed both attention checks, (3) had a mean residence time w standard deviations of the group average, and (4) spent on average at least two digs per plan re sufficient exposure to patch types.

**ow many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size?**

**ed to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.**

will continue recruitment until 200 participants have complete task data, complete data or egistered questionnaire measures, and satisfy the preregistered behavioral inclusion criteria.

**nything else you would like to pre-register?**

**secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)**

ing else to pre-register.

**y type:** Experiment

**source:** Prolific

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